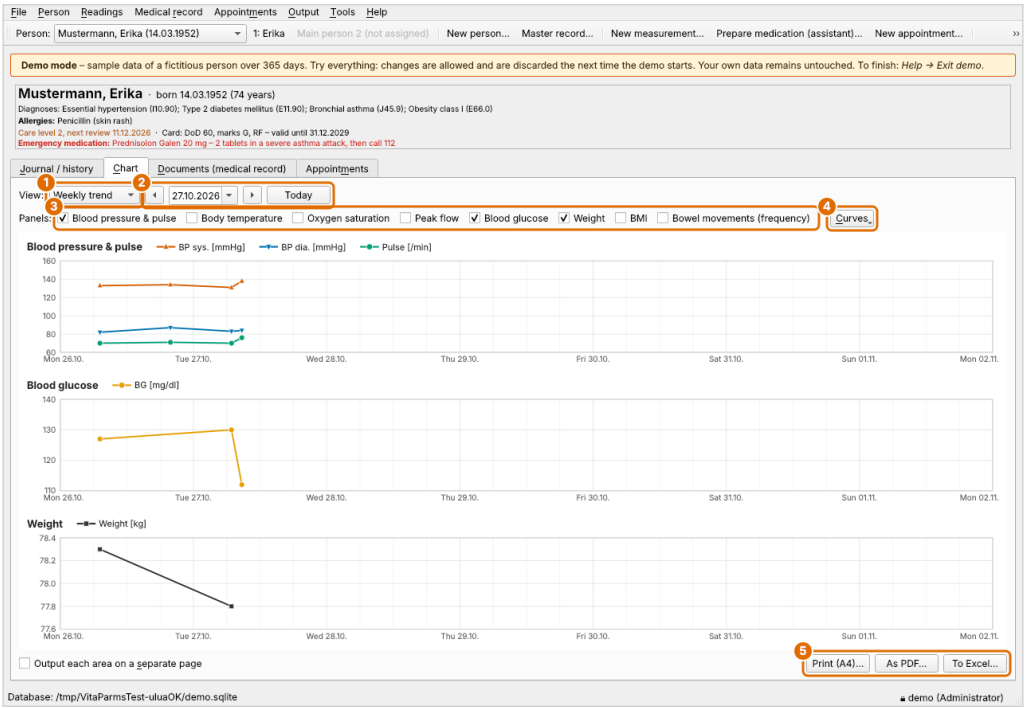
VitaParms

Vital signs, medication and appointments

Getting Started

How do I do what?
The quick guide with examples

Version 0.20.0
for Windows, macOS, Linux and Android tablets



Michael Bergmann

October 2026

VitaParms – Getting Started
Quick guide for program version 0.20.0, as of October 2026

© 2026 Michael Bergmann
Web: https://mbergmann-sh.de GitHub: https://github.com/mbergmann-sh

VitaParms is free software (open source) under the MIT licence and is provided free of charge. This booklet may be copied, modified and passed on under the same conditions; the copyright notice must be retained.

Not a medical device. VitaParms is a personal diary for health-related data. It does not make diagnoses, does not give treatment recommendations and does not replace medical or pharmaceutical advice. Use at your own risk. In an emergency call **112** (**999** in the UK, **911** in North America).

Sample data: All people, addresses, telephone numbers, readings, diagnoses and appointments shown are fictitious. The medicines shown are examples only and are not a recommendation.

Trademarks: All product and company names mentioned are trademarks or registered trademarks of their respective owners.

Every function is described in detail in the **user manual**: in VitaParms under Help › User manual or with the F1 key.

Contents

1 How to use this booklet 1

2 The first start 2

3 Getting to know the main window 6

4 Adding a person 8

5 Recording readings 11

6 Viewing and printing the trend as a chart 14

7 Recording and discontinuing medication 16

8 Preparing medication – daily or for the whole week 19

9 Stock and reordering 21

10 Creating an appointment and being reminded 23

11 Appointments that repeat 27

12 The tablet 32

13 Important at the end: back up, lock, find help 35

1 How to use this booklet

This booklet shows you with examples how to work with VitaParms. You do not need any previous knowledge. Each guide starts with a blue box that tells you what you will achieve. Then come the steps – one after the other.

1.1 Practise without risk: the demo

All examples use the **demo**. The demo is a second program window with made-up data: it already contains the sample person **Erika Mustermann** with readings from a whole year, a medication plan and appointments. You will add her husband **Max Mustermann** yourself in Chapter 4.

> **Tip:** You cannot break anything in the demo. It is created afresh every time it starts. Your own data are not affected at all.

How to open the demo:

- at the very first start with the [Try the demo] button (Chapter 2),
- later at any time via [Help] › [Start demo database…].

1.2 What the symbols in this booklet mean

Looks like	Means
[Save]	a button on the screen – click it
[Appointments] › [New appointment…]	a menu: first click ‘Appointments’ in the menu bar, then ‘New appointment…’
Timing	the label of an input field
Chart	a tab (an index card) in the window
[Ctrl] + [N]	keys: hold down ‘Ctrl’ and press ‘N’
① ② ③	orange numbers: you will find them in the picture exactly where the text is talking about
①	a step – please do them in order

Three kinds of box appear again and again:

> **Tip:** A tip makes work easier, but is not required.

Caution: Take care here – for example before you delete something.

What if . . . ? What you can do if something does not look like the picture.

1.3 If you want to know more

This booklet shows the most important ways. The **user manual** describes every function in detail. In VitaParms you open it with the F1 key or via Help › User manual. You will find this booklet in the same menu under Help › Getting Started.

Legal note: VitaParms is a **diary** for your health data – **not a medical device**. It does not make diagnoses and does not replace a doctor or a pharmacy. If you have symptoms, ask your doctor; in an emergency call the emergency number.

2 The first start

You start VitaParms for the first time, choose the language and open the demo for practising. After that you create your own, encrypted database.

2.1 Choose the language

1. Start VitaParms: on Windows from the Start menu or the desktop icon, on macOS in the ‘Applications’ folder, on Linux from the applications menu.
2. At the very first start VitaParms asks for the language. Click Deutsch (1) or English (2).

Tip: You can change the language later at any time: Tools › Settings. . . . The ‘Getting Started’ booklet and the user manual always open in the chosen language.

2.2 Confirm the notice

Next VitaParms reminds you that it is a diary and not a medical device.



Fig. 1: The language choice only appears at the very first start

1. Read the notice.
2. Click Understood. The tick at *Do not show this notice again* makes sure it does not come back at the next start.

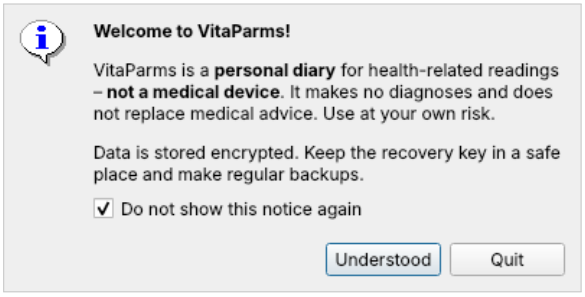


Fig. 2: The notice at the first start

2.3 Setting up: demo, new database or import

There is no database yet. VitaParms therefore shows the 'Set up VitaParms' window with four options:

1. **Create new database** for your own data (Section 2.4).
2. **Import database…** if you already use VitaParms on another computer and want to take the data with you (a `*.vpdb` file or a backup).
3. **Getting Started** opens this booklet.
4. **Try the demo** opens the demo in a second window.

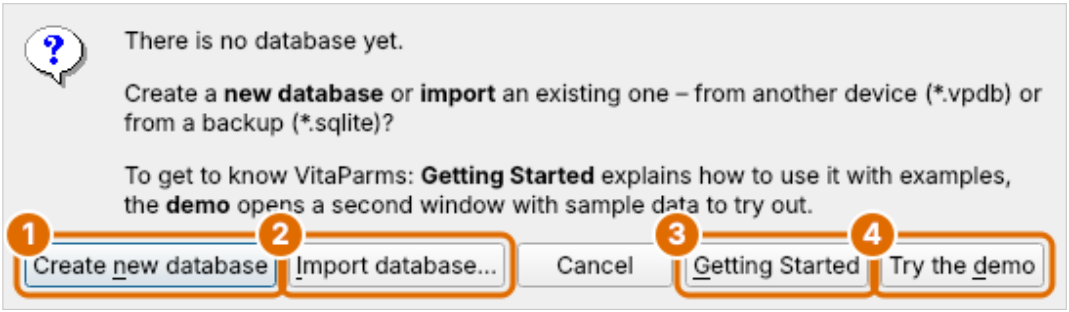


Fig. 3: Four ways at the first start

1. First click Try the demo 4. After a few seconds the demo window opens with Erika Mustermann. You are logged in there automatically.
2. The 'Set up VitaParms' window stays open. Simply leave it in the background.
3. Practise in the demo with chapters 3 to 11.

2.4 Create your own database

When you have practised enough, create your own database. All data in it are stored encrypted.

1. Close the demo window (Help › Exit demo).
2. In the 'Set up VitaParms' window click Create new database 1.
3. Enter an *Account name*, for example your first name.
4. Type a *Password* and below it, at *Repeat password*, the same once more. It must be at least 8 characters long. A short sentence such as 'My cat is called Moritz' is more secure than a complicated word.
5. Click Save. This first account is the **administrator**: it may do everything, including creating further accounts.

Now VitaParms shows the **recovery key**. With it you can get back to your data if you forget the password.

6. Click Print... and put the sheet with your important papers – not next to the computer.
7. Tick *I have stored the recovery key safely* and click Done.

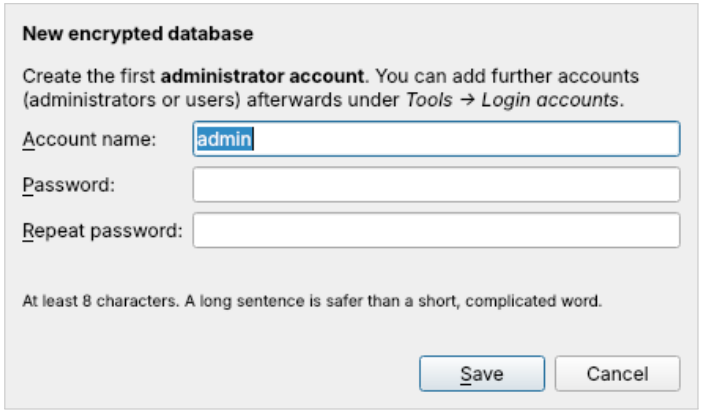


Fig. 4: Creating the first login account



Fig. 5: The recovery key – please print it

> **Caution:** Without the password *and* without the recovery key the data can no longer be opened – by nobody, not even by the author of the program.

2.5 Logging in

At every further start VitaParms asks for account and password.

1. Check the name in the *Account* field (1).
2. Type your *Password* (2).
3. Click Log in (3) or press Enter.

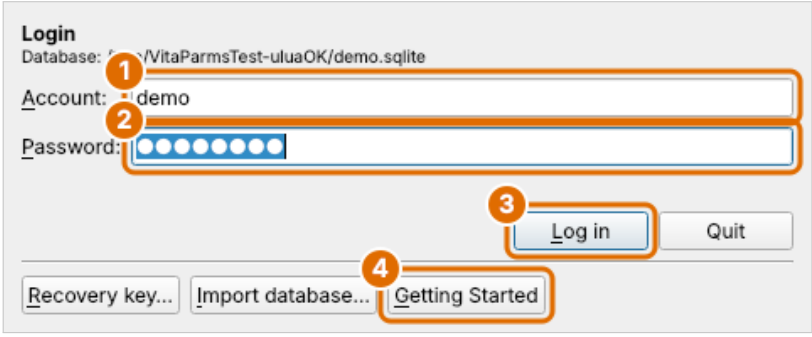


Fig. 6: Logging in – 4 opens this booklet even without logging in

What if . . . ?

- **'Account or password is wrong':** Watch upper and lower case and whether Caps Lock is switched on.
- **Forgotten the password:** Click Recovery key. . . and type in the printed key. Then you set a new password.
- **VitaParms locks itself after a while without input:** That is intended and protects your data. Simply log in again.

3 Getting to know the main window

You find your way around the main window: Where do I choose the person? Where are the readings, the chart and the appointments?

1 **Person** Here you choose the person you are dealing with. VitaParms can keep the data of several people separately – for example your own and those of your partner. Everything you do afterwards applies to the person chosen here.

2 **Tabs** One click on a tab changes the view: **Journal / history** shows all readings as a list, **Chart** shows them as curves, **Documents (medical record)** holds doctors' letters and findings, **Appointments** is the appointment planner.

3 **Toolbar** The most frequent tasks with one click: new person, master record, New measurement. . . , prepare medication, new appointment, print.

4 **Journal** Each row is one measurement – the newest is at the top.

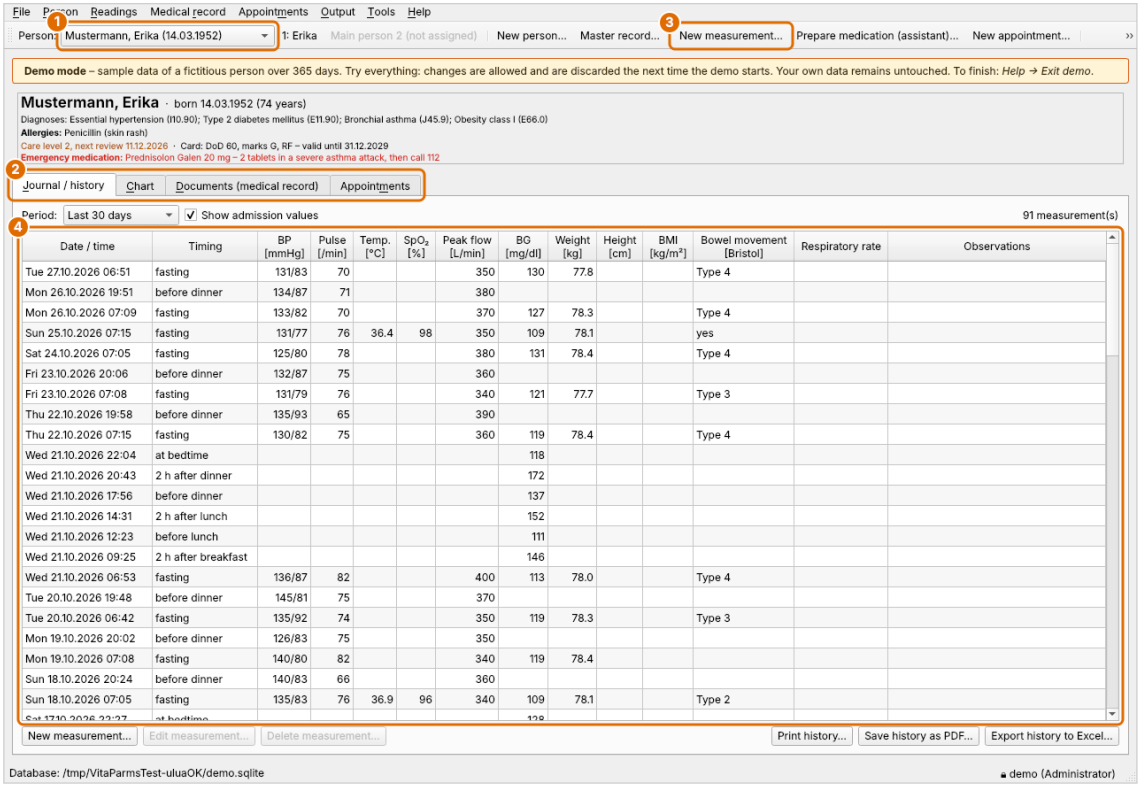


Fig. 7: The main window of the demo with Erika Mustermann

Above the journal there is a **header** with name, date of birth, diagnoses and allergies of the chosen person. Red lines point to important things, for example an emergency medication. In the demo a yellow bar also reminds you that you are practising.

3.1 Two people at the push of a button

To the right of the person selection there are two buttons: 1: Erika and 2: . . . . These are the **main persons**. One click is enough and VitaParms switches to that person. With the keyboard it is even faster: Ctrl + 1 and Ctrl + 2.

How to set a main person:

1. Choose the person in the list 1.
2. Click Person › Set current person as main person 2.

3.2 The most important keys

F1	open the user manual
Ctrl + M	new measurement
Ctrl + T	new appointment
Ctrl + Shift + M	prepare medication (assistant)
Ctrl + E	edit the person's master record
Ctrl + 4	show the appointment planner
Ctrl + L	lock VitaParms (for example when you leave your desk)
Ctrl + P	print

4 Adding a person

> You add Max Mustermann – with name, date of birth, address and diagnoses. Later you do the same for yourself or a relative.

Everything VitaParms needs to know permanently about a person is in the **master record**: address, diagnoses, allergies, medication plan, care level, disability card and advance directives.

1. Click New person… in the toolbar (or Person » New person…, keys Ctrl + Shift + N).
2. Type *Last name* 'Mustermann' and *First name* 'Max' (1). The last name is the only required field (asterisk).
3. Enter the *Date of birth* 02.07.1950 (2). You can simply type the digits one after the other; VitaParms adds the dots itself.
4. Choose the *Sex* (3).
5. Fill in address and telephone as far as you like.
6. At the top click the **Diagnoses** tab (4).
7. Write each diagnosis on a line of its own (1), ideally with the ICD code from the doctor's letter, and enter allergies and intolerances (2).
8. Click Save (Fig. 8, (5)).

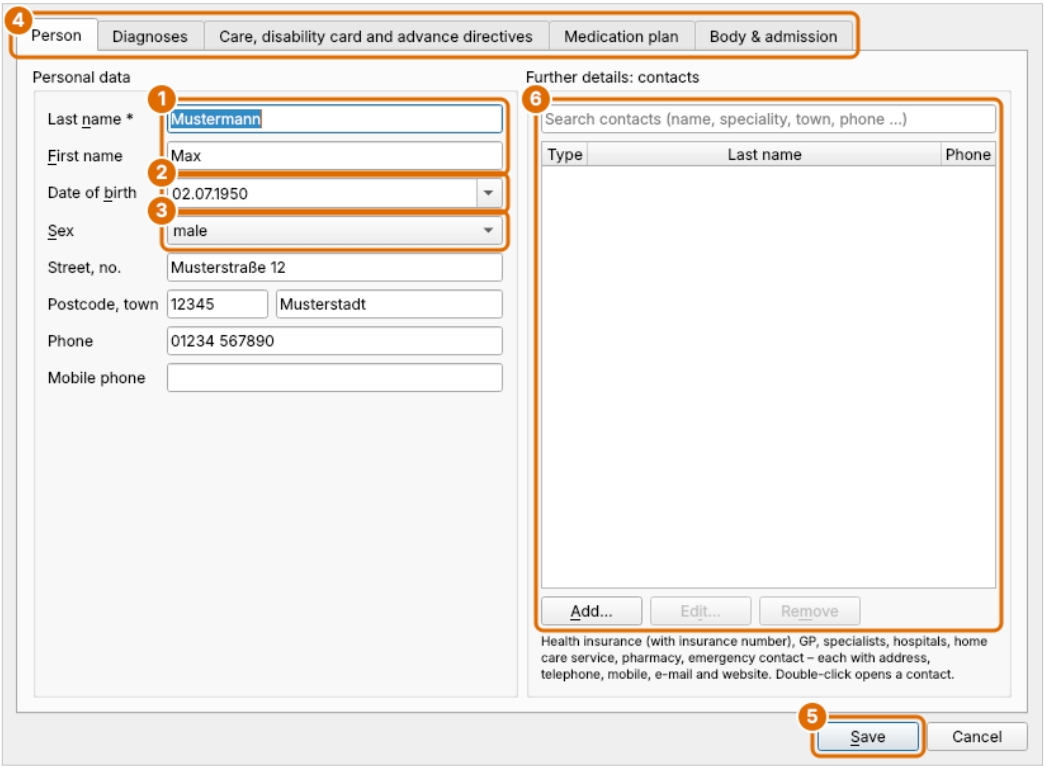


Fig. 8: The master record of a new person

Max Mustermann now appears in the person selection. Diagnoses and allergies are shown in the header of the main window – and later on every printout.

4.1 Entering health insurance, doctors and other contacts

On the right of the master record there is the list of **contacts** (Fig. 8, 6): health insurance, GP practice, specialists, hospitals, home care service, pharmacy and an emergency contact. You can enter as many as you like. The search field above the list finds a contact again quickly – just type part of the name, the town or the telephone number.

1. Click Add... below the list.

2. Choose the *Type* 1, for example 'Health insurance'. If health insurance or GP practice are still missing, VitaParms suggests them itself.

3. Enter the name 2. For the health insurance, the *Insurance number* 3 belongs with it – it is printed on the insurance card.

4. Add the address 4 as well as telephone, mobile, e-mail and website 5, as far as known. The ↗ button next to e-mail and website writes an e-mail or opens the

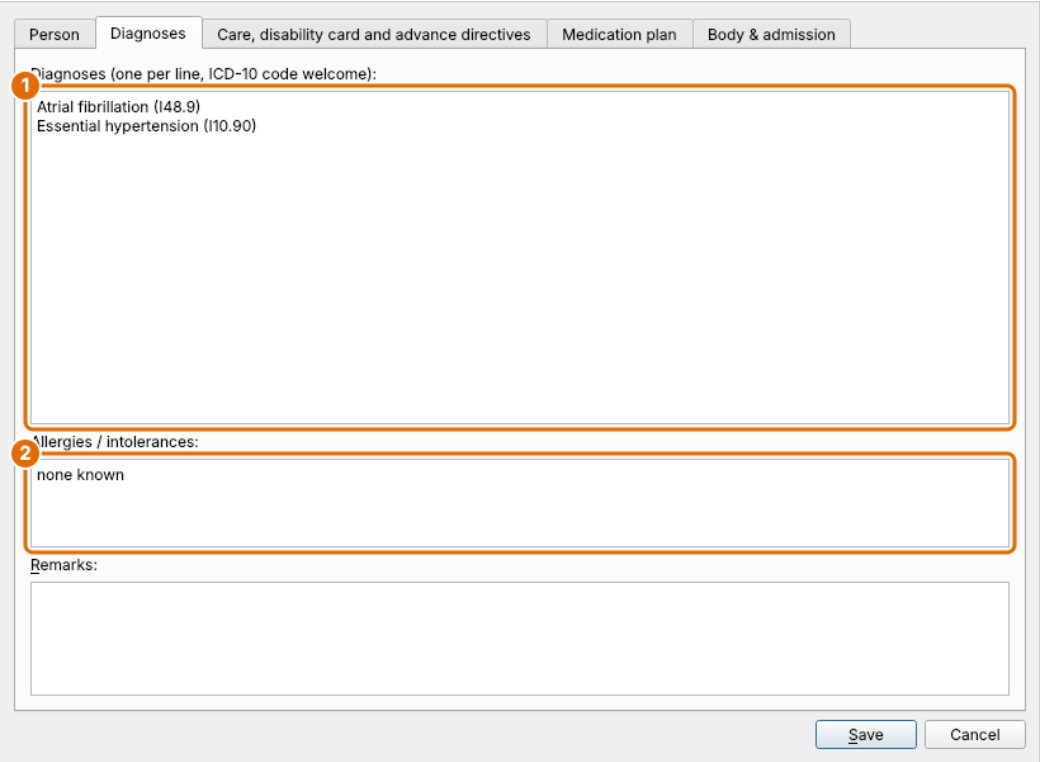


Fig. 9: Diagnoses and allergies

website.

5. Click Apply 6.

6. Create the GP practice in the same way, then specialists (with *Speciality,* for example 'Cardiology'), hospitals and the emergency contact (with *Relationship,* for example 'wife').

7. Finally click Save in the master record.

You change a contact with a double-click; Remove deletes it after asking. All contacts appear on the printed master record; health insurance and GP practice also on the medication list for the pharmacy.

4.2 Changing a master record later

1. Choose the person.

2. Click Master record… (Ctrl + E).

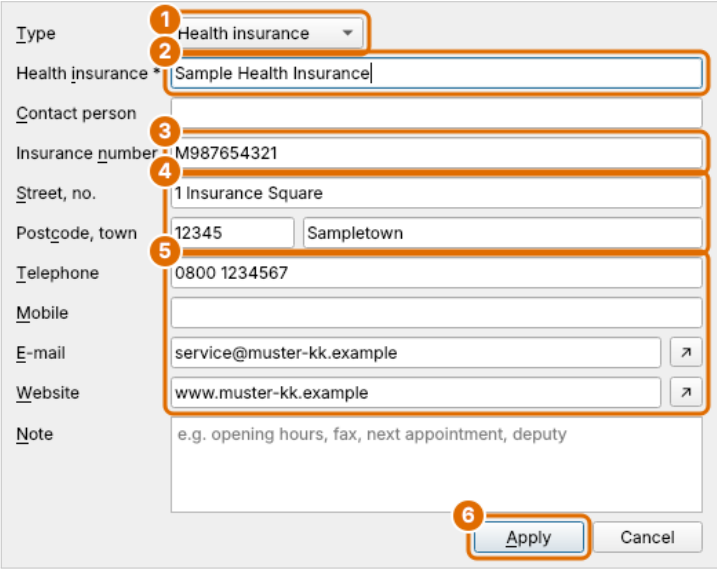


Fig. 10: A contact: the health insurance with insurance number

3. Change what is necessary and click Save.

You will only need the other tabs of the master record – **Care, disability card and advance directives**, **Medication plan** and **Body & admission** – later. The medication plan is explained in Chapter 7.

> **Tip:** If a person is missing an arm or a leg, enter this under **Body & admission**. VitaParms then takes it into account when calculating the BMI.

5 Recording readings

> You enter a measurement for Erika Mustermann: blood pressure, pulse, blood glucose and a short observation. Then you find the measurement again in the journal and correct it.

5.1 Entering a measurement

1. At the top choose the person 'Mustermann, Erika' (or click 1: Erika).
2. Click New measurement… (Ctrl + M).

3. Date and time are already set to ‘now’ (1). If you measured earlier, change the time; Now sets it back to the current time.

4. Choose the *Timing* (2), for example ‘fasting’ or ‘2 h after lunch’. This is important for blood glucose values.

5. Enter the values. For blood pressure (3) the upper value (systolic) goes into the left field, the lower one (diastolic) into the right. Leave fields you did not measure empty – they then show a dash.

6. If needed, write down an *Observation* (4), for example ‘slight headache’.

7. Click Save (5).

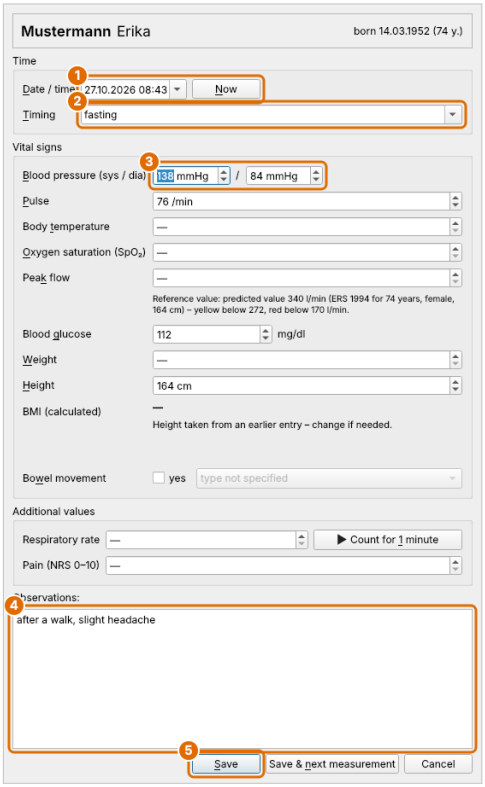


Fig. 11: A new measurement

Tip:

- With the Tab key you jump to the next field – you do not have to reach for the mouse.
- VitaParms takes the *Height* from the last entry. The *BMI* is calculated automatically as soon as a weight is entered.

- Several measurements one after another, for instance for a **blood glucose day profile**: click Save & next measurement. The window stays open and is ready for the next measurement.
- **Bowel movement:** tick *yes* and choose the type next to it on the Bristol scale (type 1 hard to type 7 liquid); amount, colour and remarks can be added below. After three days without an entry VitaParms reminds you in the header of the main window. The *bowel movement log* and the *daily glucose profiles* are in the *Output* menu.
- To count breaths, Count for 1 minute starts a clock. A sound marks the start and – after exactly one minute – the end. Then type in the number.

5.2 Finding, changing and deleting measurements in the journal

The new measurement is now at the very top of the journal 1.

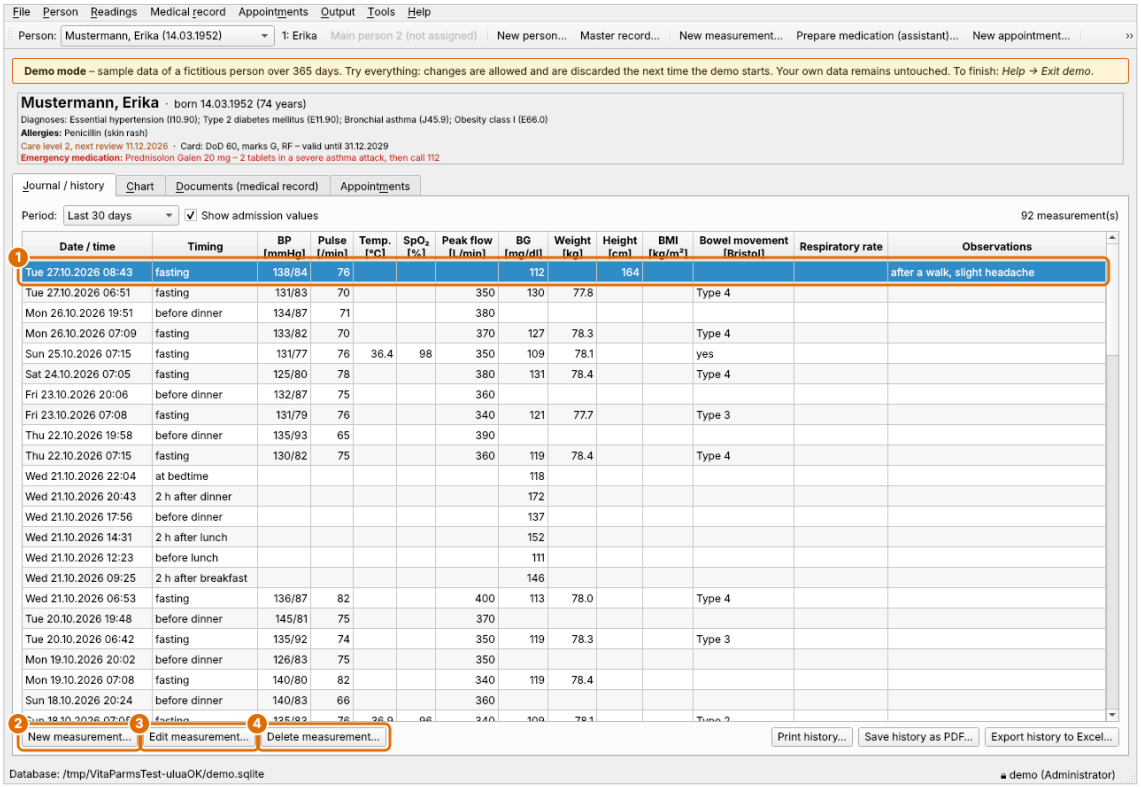


Fig. 12: The new measurement in the journal

2 **New measurement...** enters another measurement.

3 **Edit measurement...** opens the selected measurement for changing. Faster: double-click the row or press F2.

4 **Delete measurement…** removes the selected measurement after asking.

At the top left, *Period* sets how far back the journal goes, for example ‘Last 30 days’. At the bottom right you print the list, save it as a PDF file or export it for Excel – for the next visit to the doctor, for example.

What if …?

- **The measurement does not appear:** Is the right person chosen at the top? Does the *Period* go back far enough?
- **A row is in bold:** These are the **admission values** from the master record. If they are in the way, untick *Show admission values*.

6 Viewing and printing the trend as a chart

You look at Erika’s blood pressure and blood glucose of the last week as curves, page back to the previous week and print the result on an A4 sheet for the doctor’s appointment.

1. Click the **Chart** tab.
2. At *View* 1 choose the period the chart shows: ‘Daily profile’, ‘Weekly trend’, ‘Monthly trend’, ‘Yearly trend’ or ‘Custom period’ (from–to).
3. With the arrows 2 you page one day, week, month or year back or forward. Today jumps back to the current period.
4. Under *Panels* 3 tick what you want to see, for example ‘Blood pressure & pulse’, ‘Blood glucose’ and ‘Weight’.

Each curve has its own colour and its own marker (circle, triangle, square …). So the curves can still be told apart on a black-and-white printout.

Tip:

- Point the mouse at a dot: VitaParms shows the exact value and the time.
- Clicking an entry of the **legend** (for example ‘Pulse’) hides this curve; a second click brings it back. The Curves button 4 does the same.
- If you have ticked many panels, the chart becomes taller than the window. A scroll bar then appears on the right – scroll down with the mouse wheel.

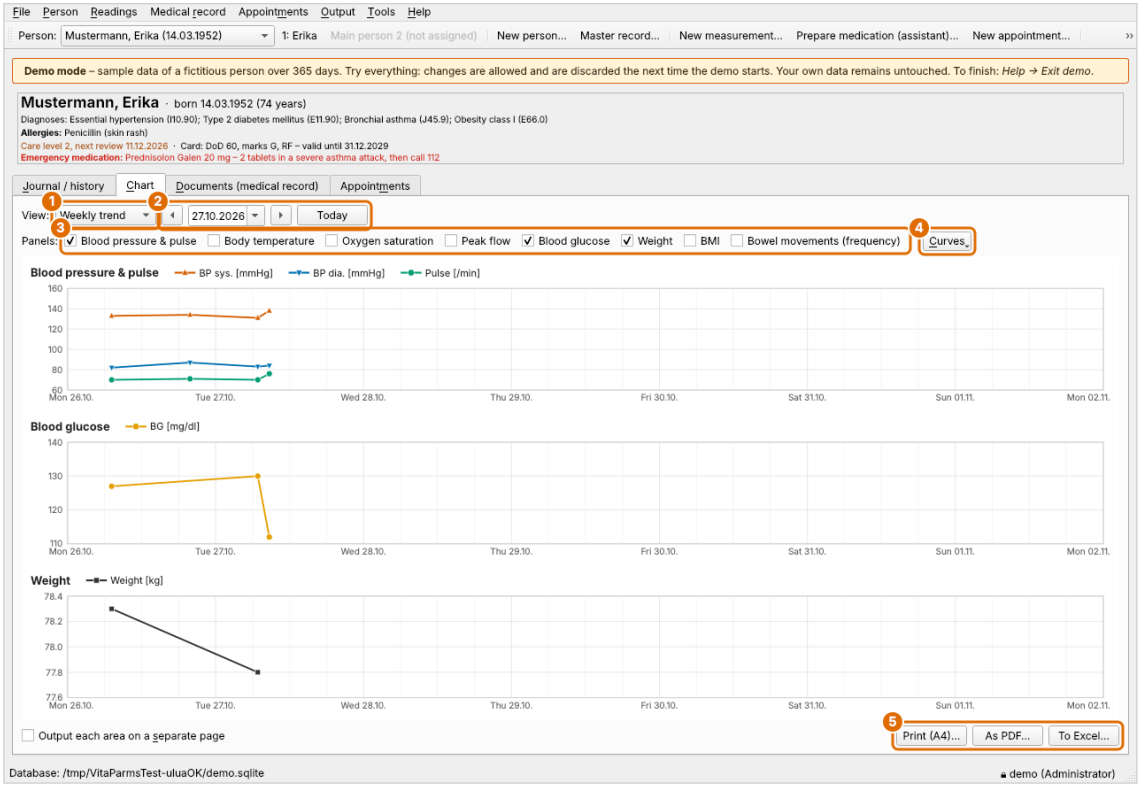


Fig. 13: The chart: weekly trend with three panels

- In the yearly trend VitaParms combines each day into one dot: the dot is the mean, a vertical line reaches from the lowest to the highest value of the day.

6.1 Outputting the chart

At the bottom right there are three buttons 5:

Print (A4)... prints the chart on an A4 sheet, with name, period and legend.

As PDF... saves the same as a PDF file, for example to send by e-mail.

To Excel... saves the readings as a table for Excel or LibreOffice.

Tip: Tick *Output each area on a separate page* beforehand if every curve should get a whole sheet – that is easier to read on paper.

7 Recording and discontinuing medication

> You look at Erika's medication plan, enter a new medicine with intake reminder for Max, discontinue a medicine and print the plan.

7.1 Opening the medication plan

The medication plan is part of the person's master record.

1. Choose Erika Mustermann and click Master record… (Ctrl + E).
2. Click the **Medication plan** tab 1.

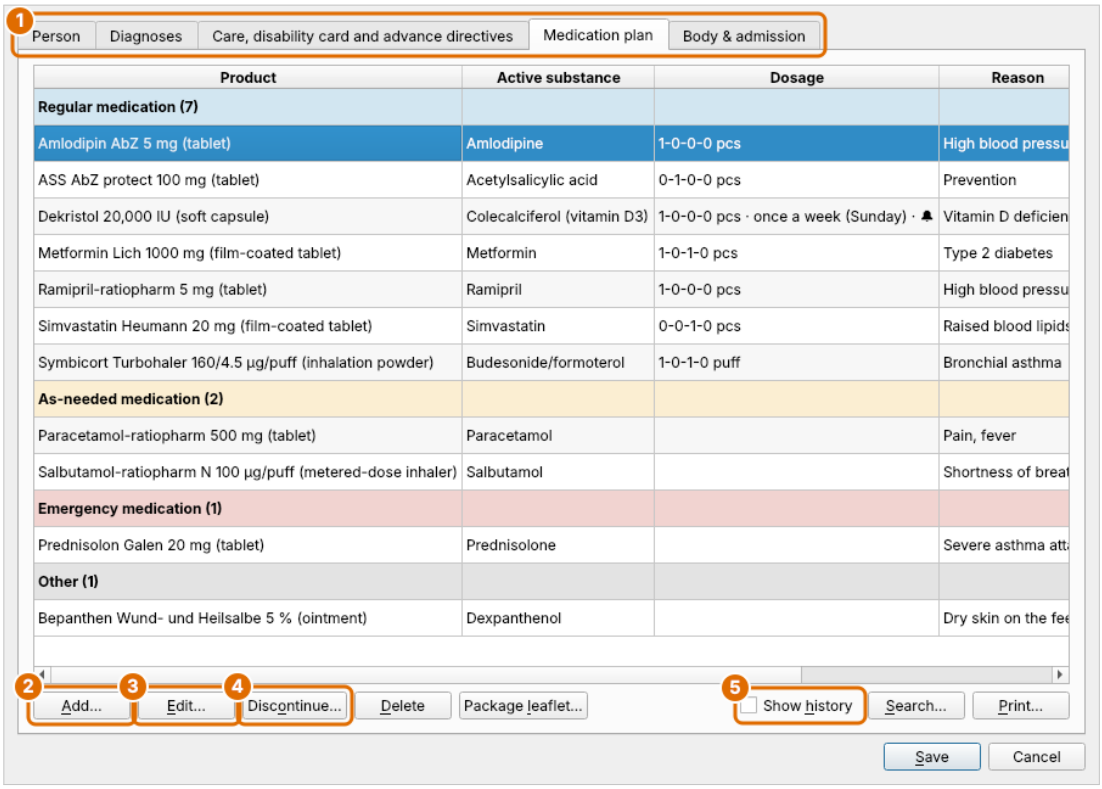


Fig. 14: Erika's medication plan in the master record

The list is divided into groups: **regular medication** (fixed intake according to plan), **as-needed medication** (only when needed, for example for pain), **emergency medication** and **other** (such as ointments). At the bottom you find the buttons Add… 2, Edit… 3 and Discontinue… 4. With *Show history* 5 you also see medicines that were taken in the past.

7.2 Entering a new medicine

Max is prescribed a new medicine: **Metoprolol 47.5 mg**, one tablet in the morning and one in the evening, from today and without end date. VitaParms should remind him to take it.

1. Choose Max Mustermann, open his master record (Ctrl + E) and there the **Medication plan** tab.
2. Click Add. . . .
3. Enter the *Brand name* and the *Strength* 1 – as they are printed on the pack. Active substance, dosage form and reason are helpful but optional.
4. At *Dosage* 2 enter how much is taken in the morning, at noon, in the evening and at night: here '1' in the morning and '1' in the evening. Write half tablets as '½' or '0.5'. On the right choose the *Unit* (tablets, puffs, ml . . .).
5. At *Period* 3 today's date is already set. Without a tick at *until* the medicine applies **permanently** until you discontinue it. Only for a course with a fixed end do you set the tick and choose the last day of intake.
6. Tick *Remind me to take it* 4. Choose the weekdays and the times. VitaParms adds the reminders to the appointment planner.
7. Click OK 5.
8. **Important:** Afterwards click Save in the master record. Only then is the medicine saved.

Tip:

- Not every medicine is taken daily. At *Schedule* you set 'every . . . days', 'on certain weekdays' or 'monthly' – for example vitamin D 'once a week on Sunday'.
- At *Type* you choose whether it is regular, as-needed or emergency medication.
- VitaParms usually sets the ticks under *Classification* (for example 'Blood thinner') itself. Check them anyway.

7.3 Discontinuing a medicine

The GP stops Erika's amlodipine. You can also discontinue a medicine only **from a later day** – until then it continues to be given.

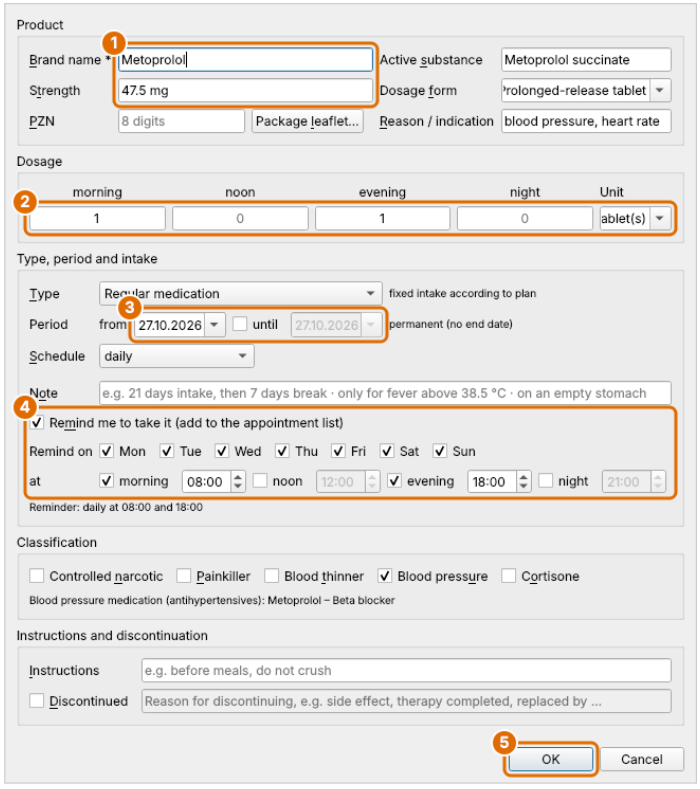


Fig. 15: A new medicine with reminder

1. Open Erika's medication plan and click the medicine.
2. Click Discontinue...
3. At *Discontinued on* (1) choose the date: today or a day in the future.
4. Write down a *Reason* (2), for example 'changed by the GP'.
5. Click Discontinue (3) and then Save in the master record.

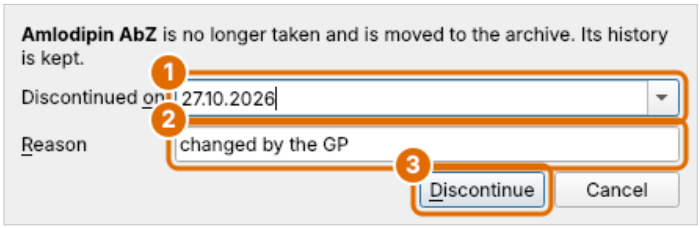


Fig. 16: Discontinuing a medicine

The medicine disappears from the current plan and is moved to the **archive**. You see it when you tick *Show history*. A medicine with a fixed end date is archived by VitaParms

automatically after the last day.

> **What if …? Discontinued by mistake?** Tick *Show history*, click the medicine and then Resume. A discontinuation planned for later is withdrawn with Discontinue… and Cancel discontinuation.

7.4 Printing the medication plan

1. Choose the person.
2. Click Person › Print › Medication list… – for the doctor or for yourself.
3. For the pharmacy there is Person › Print › Medication list for the pharmacy…: it also contains active substances, PZN, weight, allergies and diagnoses, so that the pharmacy can check for interactions.
4. A preview opens. Check it and click the printer symbol at the top.

8 Preparing medication – daily or for the whole week

> You fill Erika's pill box with the help of the assistant. VitaParms shows each medicine in large print, reads it aloud if you wish and records in the log who prepared what and when.

8.1 Preparing for one day (daily pill box)

1. Choose Erika Mustermann.
2. Click Prepare medication (assistant)… in the toolbar (Ctrl + Shift + M).
3. Leave *Prepare* 1 at 'daily'. At *Time of day* 2 choose 'all times' – or only 'in the morning' if you only fill the morning compartment. Next to it you choose the day.
4. The assistant shows the first medicine: name, strength and, in the blue cell, how much goes into which compartment. Put the tablets into the box.
5. Click Next ▶ 3. The next medicine appears. Repeat reads the current one aloud again, ◀ Back goes back one.

6 At the last medicine the button is called Done ✓. Clicking it records the preparation in the log.

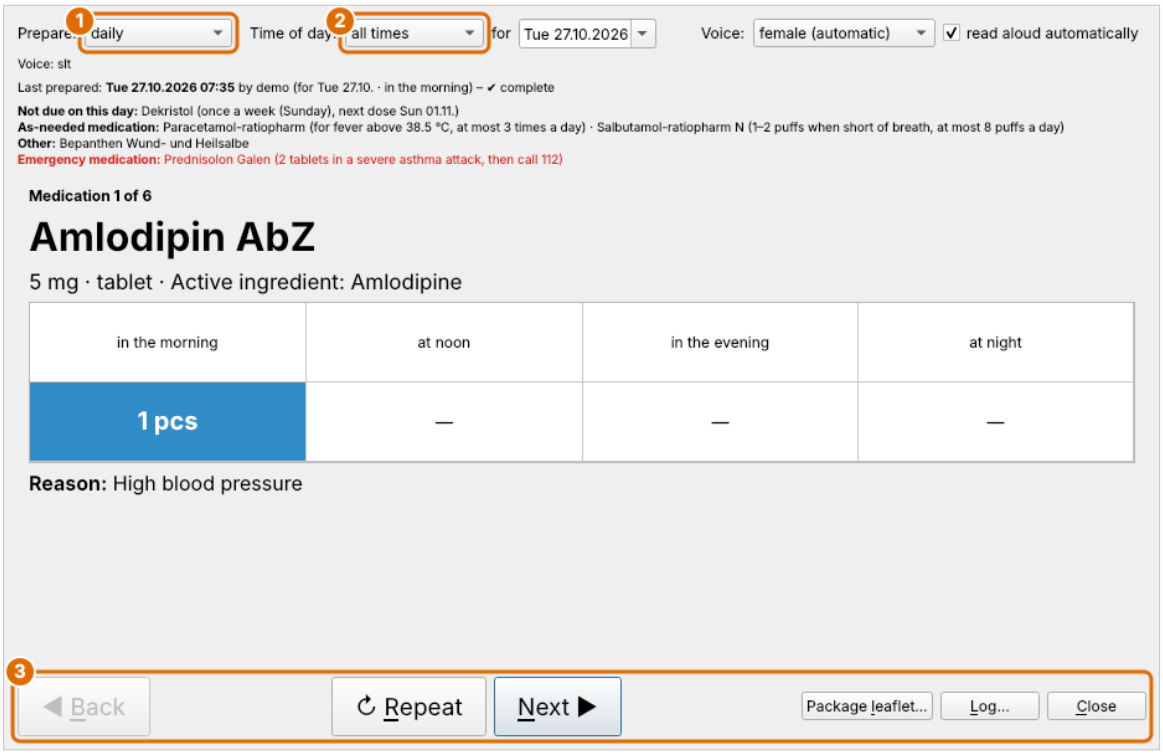


Fig. 17: The assistant: one medicine after the other

> **Tip:** With *read aloud automatically* the computer speaks each medicine aloud. This leaves both hands free. If the voice sounds strange, no suitable system voice is installed for the language – the display on the screen is still correct.

8.2 Preparing for a whole week (weekly pill box)

Many people fill the box once a week. There is a week view for that.

1 At *Prepare* 1 choose ‘weekly (7 days)’.

2 At *from* choose the first day of the week you are filling.

3 For each medicine a table shows all seven days with all compartments. Fill the box row by row and then click Next ▶.

4 With Done ✓ VitaParms records the whole week in the log.

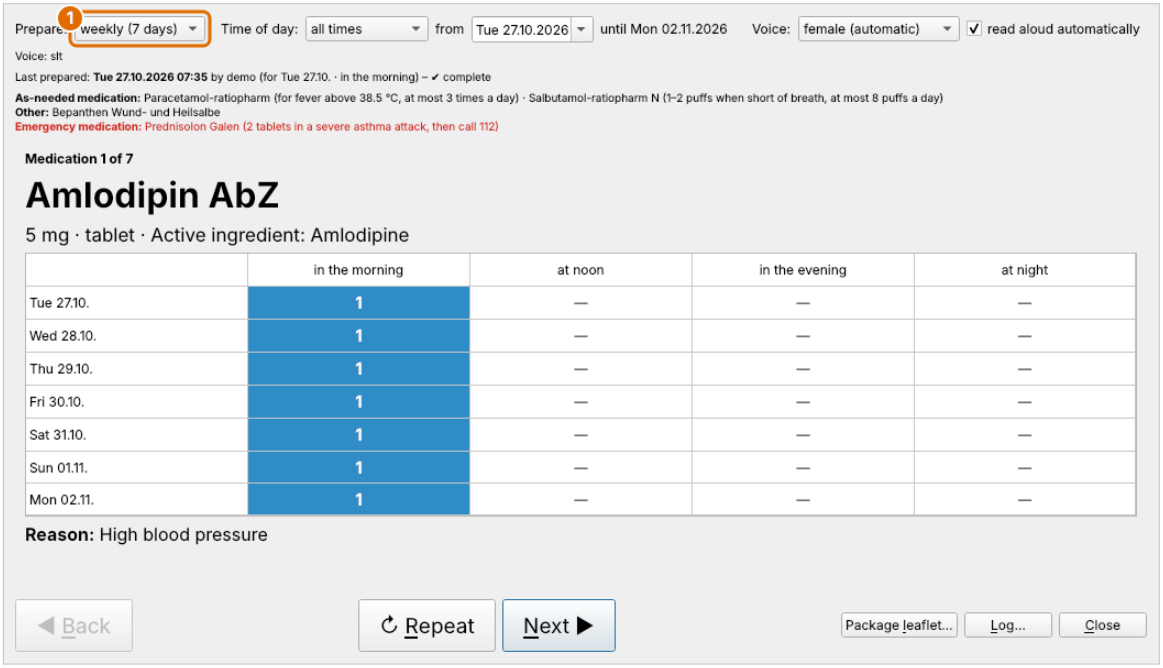


Fig. 18: Week view: seven days at a glance

VitaParms remembers whether you prepare daily or weekly and also calculates the stock accordingly (Chapter 9).

What if . . . ?

- **'Nothing to prepare for this day and time':** No medicine is due on the chosen day or time – for example because a weekly medicine is only taken on Sundays. Check day and time of day.
- **Who prepared yesterday?** Click Log. . . .

9 Stock and reordering

VitaParms keeps count of how many tablets are left and warns you in good time that a medicine is almost used up and a prescription should be obtained and ordered. You learn how to receive a pack, confirm an order and book the delivery.

9.1 Receiving a pack

VitaParms only tracks the stock of medicines for which you have received at least one pack. Start with the medicines that have to be reordered regularly.

1. Choose Erika Mustermann.
2. In the Person menu choose Medication stock and orders… (Ctrl + Shift + L).
3. On the **Stock** tab click the medicine 1.
4. Click Receive pack… 2.
5. Enter the *Quantity* (for example 100 tablets) and the date at *Expires on* – it is printed on the pack.
6. Click Receive.

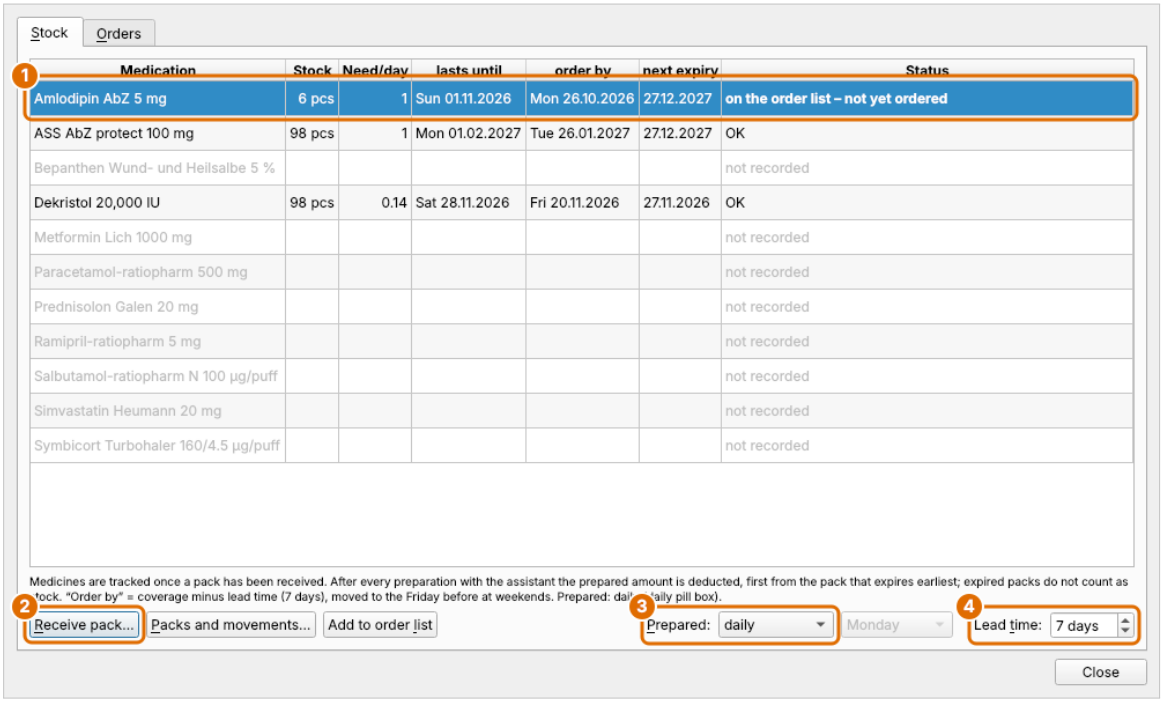


Fig. 19: The stock: how long will it last?

For each medicine the table shows the **stock**, the daily need, until when the supply **lasts** and by when you should **order** at the latest. After every preparation with the assistant (Chapter 8) VitaParms deducts the prepared amount automatically.

At the bottom you set two things:

3 **Prepared** daily or weekly – the way you fill the box.

4 **Lead time** how many days you need to get the prescription and the medicine (7 days are suggested).

Note:

- Orders cannot be placed at the weekend. If the last day to order falls on a Saturday or Sunday, VitaParms names the Friday before.
- Expired packs do not count towards the stock. If only expired packs are left, you have to reorder.

9.2 Ordering and confirming

When a medicine is running low, VitaParms puts it on the **order list** by itself and reminds you at program start – until you confirm the order.

1. Open the **Orders** tab.
2. Print the list with Print… or save it with As PDF… 2 – for the doctor's practice or the pharmacy, for example.
3. When prescription and order are done, click Confirm as ordered… 1, enter the date and click Confirm. From now on VitaParms no longer reminds you.
4. When the delivery arrives, click the item and then Book delivery… 3. Enter quantity and expiry date – done: the new pack is in stock.

All order lists are kept. You can look at them, print them or save them as PDF again at any time.

10 Creating an appointment and being reminded

Erika has a blood test at her GP's on Tuesday at 8:30. VitaParms should remind her the day before.

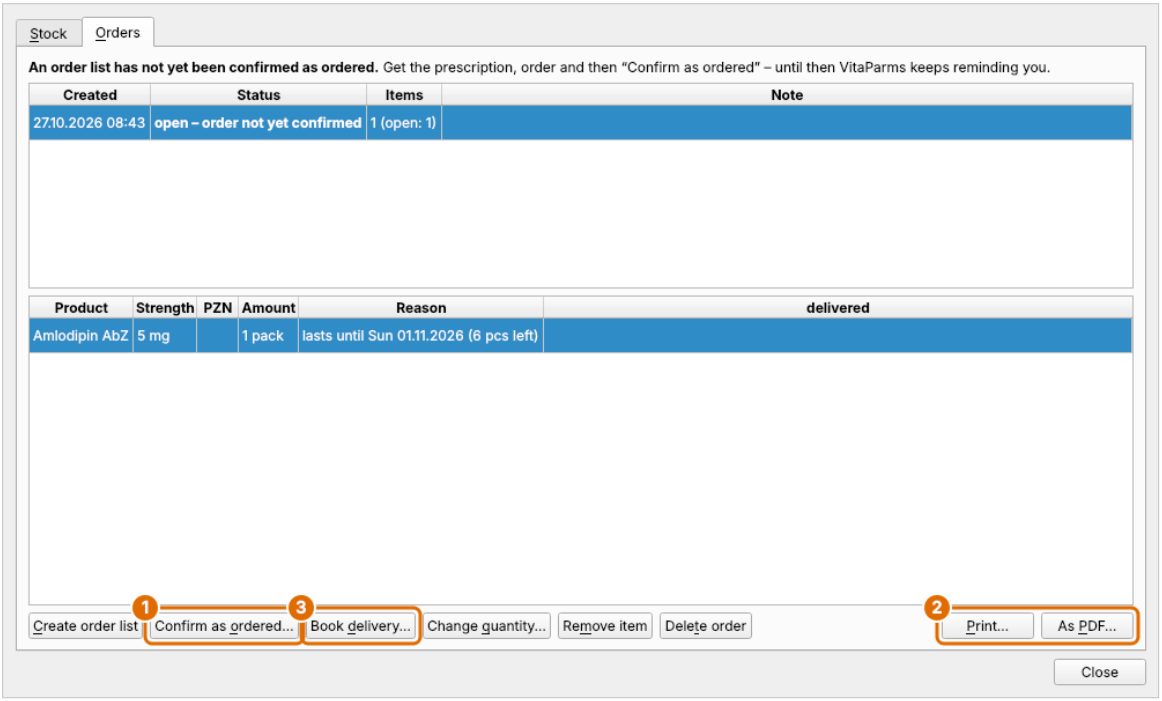


Fig. 20: The order list: print, confirm, book the delivery

10.1 Creating a single appointment

1. Click New appointment... (Ctrl + T).
2. At *Title* 1 write what it is about: 'GP: blood test'.
3. At *Start* 2 set date and time. VitaParms sets the *End* one hour later – change it if needed. For appointments without a time (a birthday, for example) tick *all day*.
4. Enter the *Location* if you like.
5. Choose the *Person* 3 the appointment is for.
6. Choose the *Priority* 4: low, normal, high or urgent. The colour later appears in the calendar.
7. Leave *Repeat* 5 at 'none' – it is a single appointment. Recurring appointments are explained in Chapter 11.
8. At *Advance notice* 6 choose when VitaParms should remind you, here '1 day before'. At *Type* leave 'visual' (a window) and 'audible' (a sound) ticked.
9. Write in the *Note* what you need to bring and click Save 7.

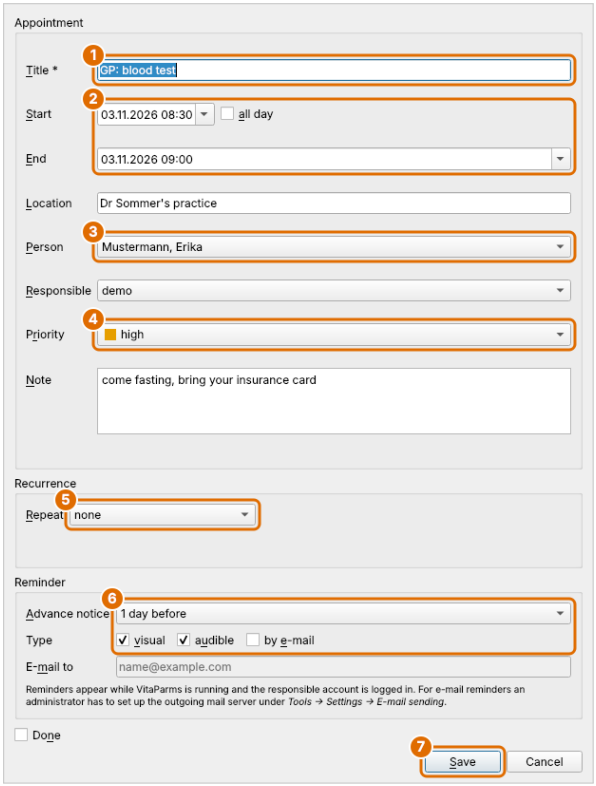


Fig. 21: A single appointment with a reminder the day before

10.2 When the reminder comes

At the set time a window appears with a sound. You have several options:

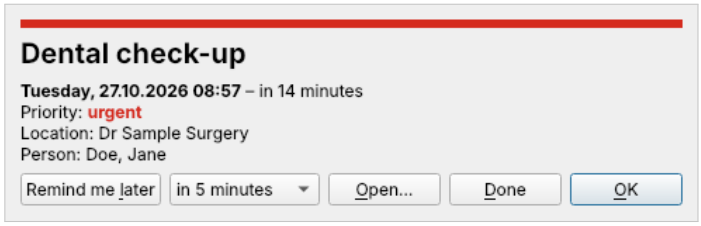


Fig. 22: The reminder of an appointment

OK reminder seen – the window closes.

Remind me later reminds you again after the time chosen on the right, for example ‘in 5 minutes’.

Done ticks off the appointment.

Open... shows the appointment for changing.

> **Note:** Reminders appear while VitaParms is running and the responsible account is logged in. So leave VitaParms open – a locked VitaParms reminds you after logging in. At program start VitaParms also shows today's and tomorrow's appointments.

10.3 The appointment planner

You see all appointments on the **Appointments** tab (Ctrl + 4).

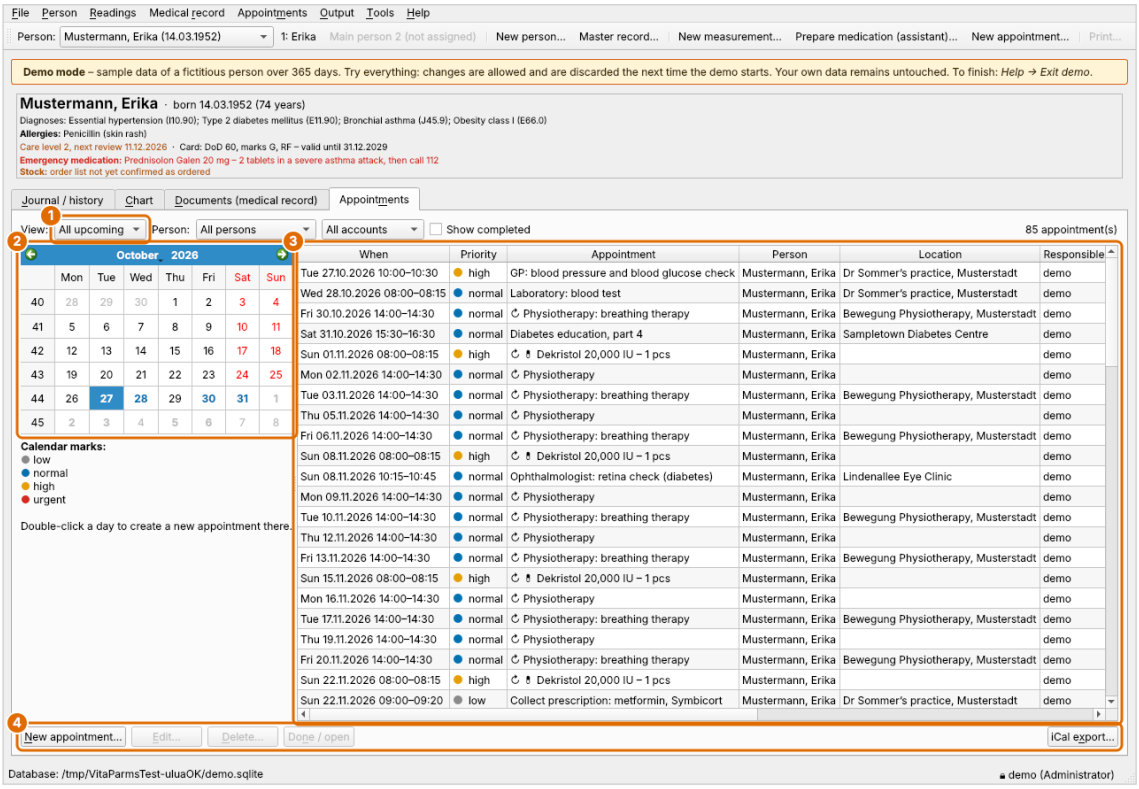


Fig. 23: The appointment planner

1. **View** day, week, month, all upcoming or all appointments.
2. **Calendar** Days with appointments are marked in colour. A click shows the appointments of that day, a double-click creates a new appointment there.
3. **List** A double-click opens an appointment for changing. The symbol ↻ marks appointments that repeat.
4. **Buttons** new appointment, edit, delete, tick off as done – and iCal export... for calendars on your smartphone.

Tip: To print a list of upcoming appointments for the fridge door or the carer, use Person › Print › Reminders…: choose the period, for example 'next 7 days', and click Preview / print….

11 Appointments that repeat

Physiotherapy twice a week, a dressing change every three days, chiropody on the second Tuesday of every month: you create such appointments once, and VitaParms enters all repetitions itself – an **appointment series**.

11.1 Which repetition fits?

You create a series like a single appointment (Chapter 10). The difference is in the *Repeat* field:

Repeat	When? – Example
daily	every day – measure blood glucose
every … days	every *n* days – dressing change every 3 days
on weekdays (Mon–Fri)	Monday to Friday – home care service
weekly	on one or more weekdays – physiotherapy Mon and Thu
every … weeks (on weekday)	every *n* weeks on the chosen day – wound check every 3 weeks on Wednesday
monthly	on the same day of the month, on the *n*th or the last weekday – chiropody on the 2nd Tuesday
yearly	once a year on the same day – flu vaccination

Below it, at *End of series*, you set when it stops:

- 'no end' – the series continues forever,
- 'until (inclusive)' – until a date,
- 'after a number of appointments' – for example after 10 appointments (matching a prescription for 10 treatments).

Below the fields a **preview** with ↻ shows how VitaParms has understood the rule, and the next dates. Check it before you save.

11.2 Example 1: physiotherapy on Mondays and Thursdays

1. Create a new appointment: *Title* ‘Physiotherapy’, *Start* next Monday at 14:00, *Person* Erika.
2. At *Repeat* choose ‘weekly’ (1).
3. At *on* (2) Monday is already ticked. Also tick ‘Thu’.
4. At *End of series* choose ‘until (inclusive)’ and the date of the last treatment (3).
5. Check the preview and click Save.

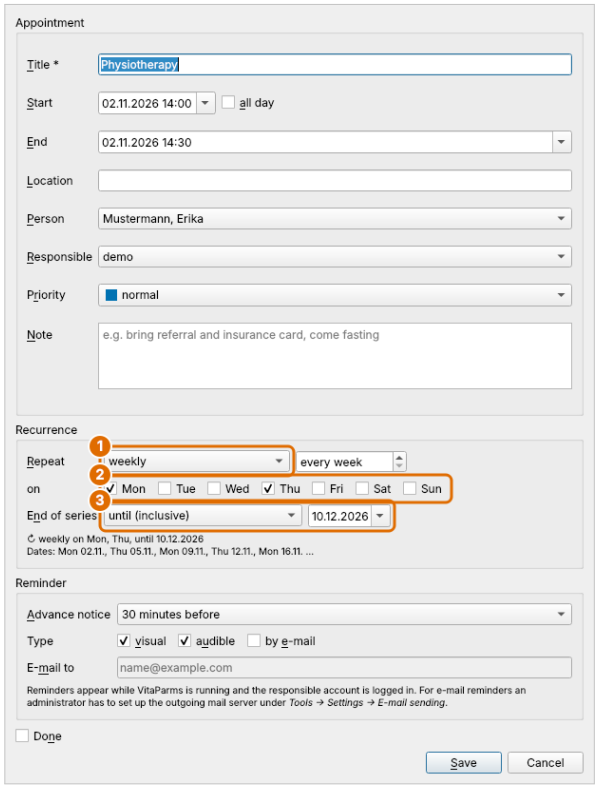


Fig. 24: Weekly on two days, until a date

11.3 Example 2: dressing change every three days

1. New appointment ‘Dressing change’, *Start* tomorrow at 9:00.
2. *Repeat*: ‘every … days’. Next to it ‘every 2 days’ appears – set ‘every 3 days’ with the small arrows.

3. *End of series*: ‘after a number of appointments’, ‘5 appointments’.

4. Save.

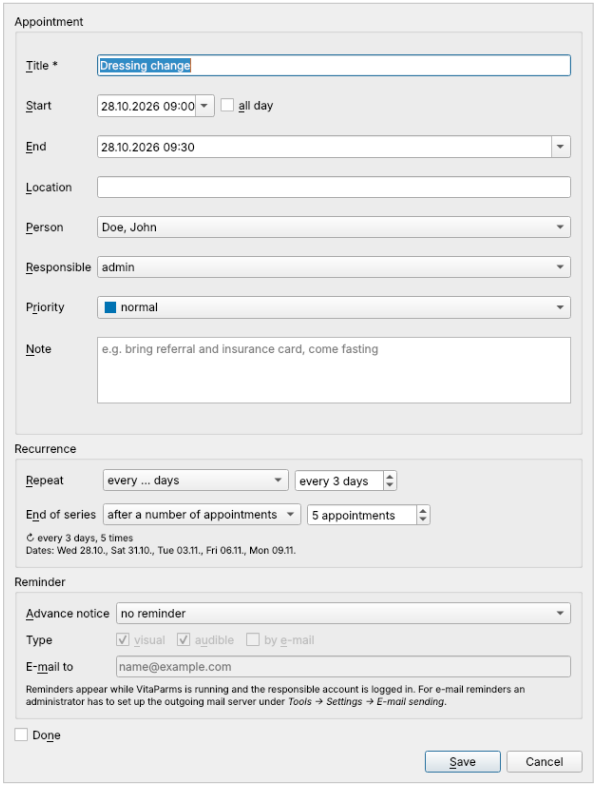


Fig. 25: Every 3 days, 5 times

11.4 Example 3: wound check every three weeks on Wednesday

1. New appointment ‘Wound care’, *Start* next Wednesday at 10:00.

2. *Repeat*: ‘every … weeks (on weekday)’. 2 weeks are suggested – set ‘every 3 weeks’. Wednesday is already ticked.

3. Choose the *End of series* and click Save.

11.5 Example 4: chiropody on the second Tuesday of the month

1. New appointment ‘Chiropody’ on the second Tuesday of next month, 10:00.

2. *Repeat*: ‘monthly’ 1.

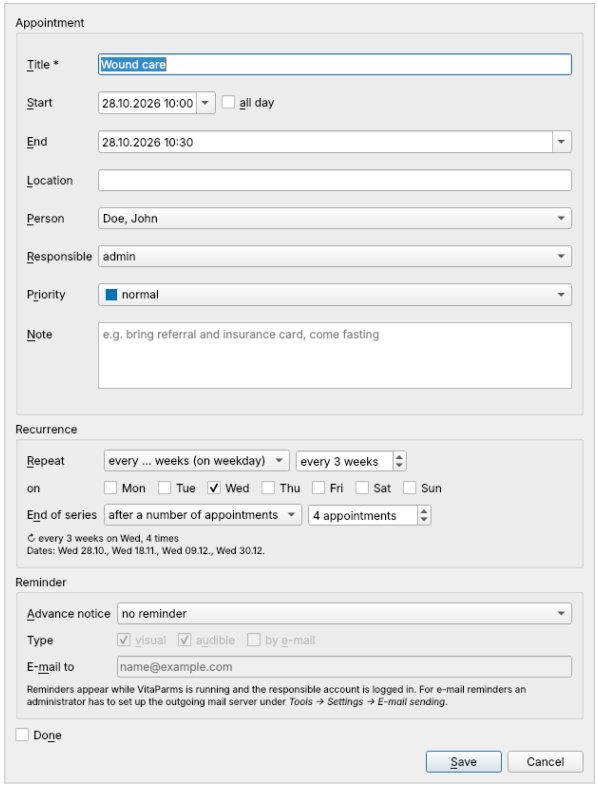


Fig. 26: Every 3 weeks on Wednesday

3. At *on* 2 choose ‘on the 2nd Tuesday’. (‘on the 10th of the month’ would mean: always on the tenth, whatever the weekday.)

4. *End of series*: ‘after a number of appointments’, ‘12 appointments’ 3 – that is one year.

5. Save.

11.6 Changing one appointment of a series

If a physiotherapy session is cancelled or moved, change only this one appointment:

1. Open the appointment in the planner with a double-click.

2. Change, for example, the time and click Save.

3. VitaParms asks what the change should apply to:

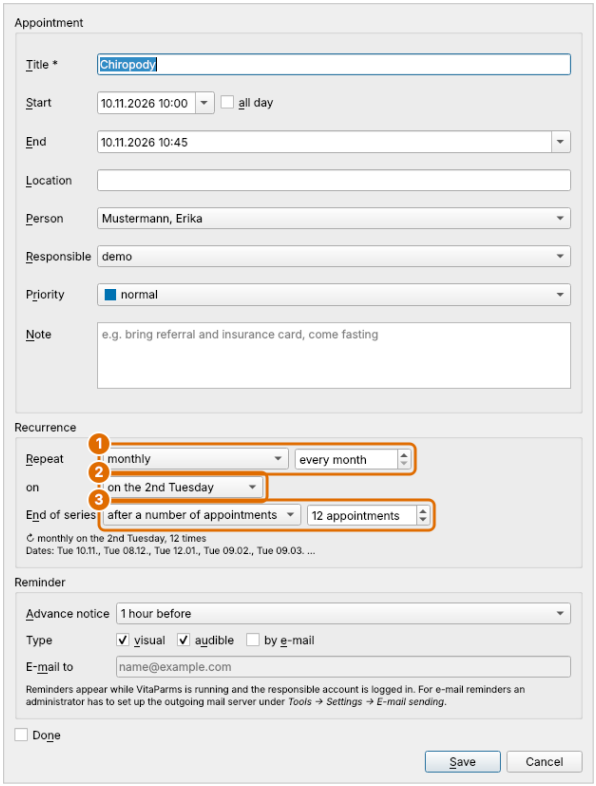


Fig. 27: Monthly on the 2nd Tuesday, 12 times

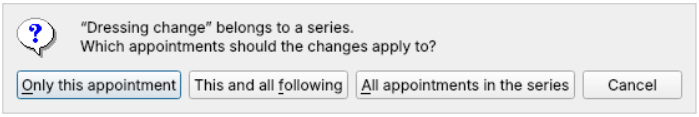


Fig. 28: Only this appointment or the whole series?

Only this appointment All other appointments stay as they are.

This and all following For example if physiotherapy is now always an hour later.

All appointments in the series also changes past appointments.

VitaParms asks the same when deleting.

> **Note:** The medication reminders (Chapter 7) also appear as series in the appointment planner. But change them in the medication plan – where you set them up.

12 The tablet

> You take your data with you on an Android tablet and enter readings there – in the living room or on the go, for example. The app is designed for large fingers and good readability.

On the tablet you record and view readings, trend charts, the master record, the medication plan, appointments and the medical record – there you simply photograph doctor's letters with the camera. How to install the app is described in the user manual, chapter 'VitaParms on a tablet'.

12.1 The first start on the tablet

1. Open the VitaParms app. Tap Deutsch or English.
2. Read the notice and confirm it.
3. On the 'Set up VitaParms' page choose how the tablet starts. At the top, Getting Started – open the quick guide opens this booklet.

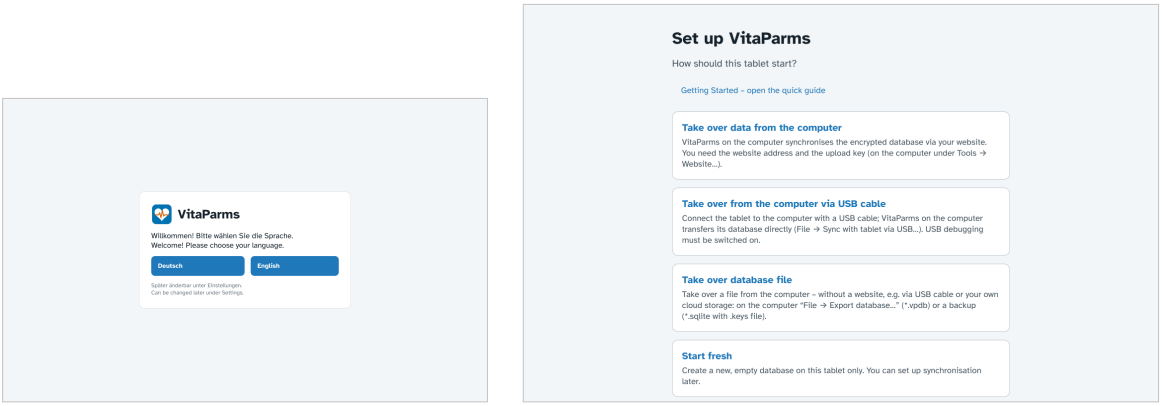


Fig. 29: Language choice and set-up on the tablet

12.2 Taking the data from the computer – with a file

The simplest way needs neither internet nor website:

1. On the **computer**: File » Export database (for another device)… . Save the file (extension `.vpdb`), for example on a USB stick or in your cloud storage.
2. Bring the file to the tablet (USB cable, cloud storage or an e-mail to yourself).

3. On the **tablet** tap Take over database file.
4. Tap Select database file… and choose the file.
5. Tap Take over database.
6. Log in with the same account and password as on the computer.

Tip: If you use both devices permanently, synchronise them – then the computer and the tablet always have the same, most recent data. This works over the **USB cable** (on the computer File › Sync with tablet via USB…, on the tablet Settings → USB sync with the computer) or automatically via your own website (Take over data from the computer). The user manual explains both in the chapter 'VitaParms on a tablet'.

12.3 A measurement on the tablet

1. Tap the person on the left and then + New reading at the top right.
2. Tap the timing, for example 'fasting'.
3. Tap a field and enter the value. The on-screen keyboard only shows digits.
4. Tap Save at the top right.

The overview then shows the newest values with a small trend line. Under **Trend charts** you find the same charts as on the computer, under **Medication** the medication plan – where you can also set up reminders.

12.4 Language and help on the tablet

Under Settings (top right) you change the language. The app switches immediately, without a restart. Next to it, Getting Started opens this booklet as a PDF.

What if …? The booklet does not open: The tablet needs an app for viewing PDF files, for example a PDF viewer from the Play Store.

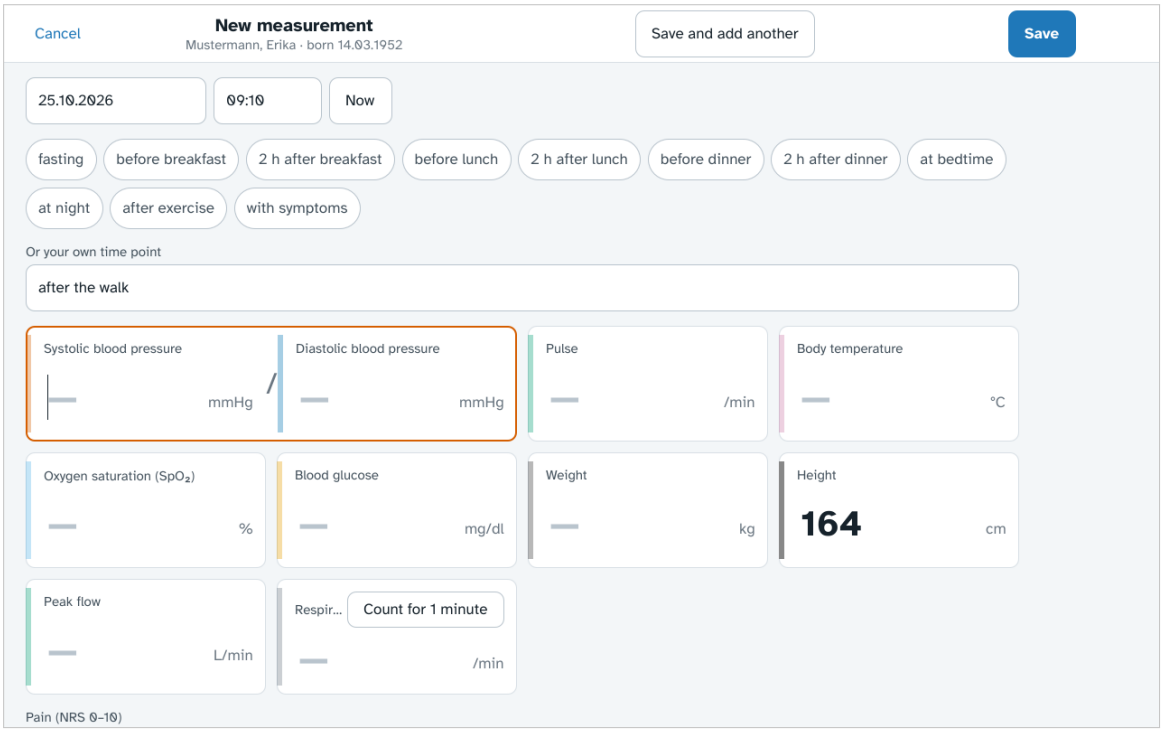


Fig. 30: A measurement on the tablet

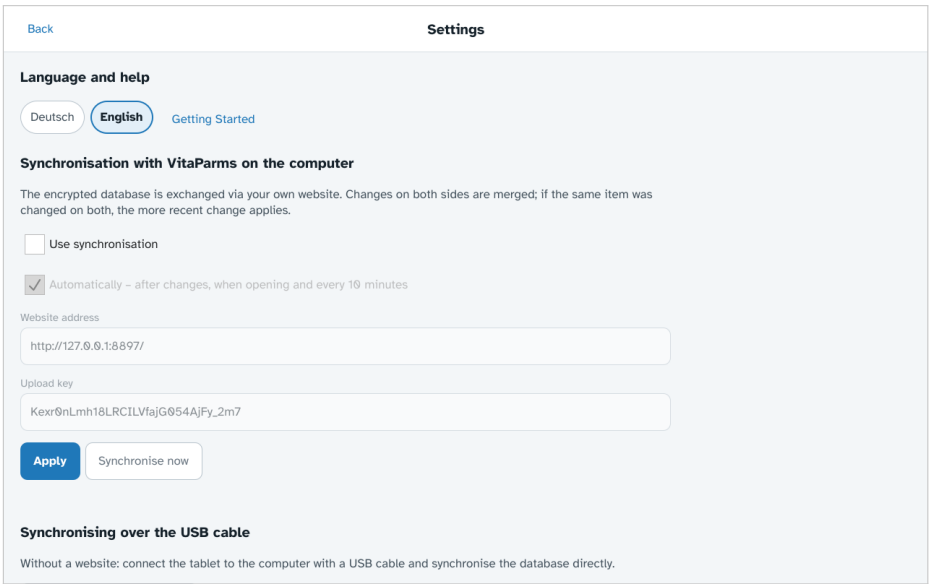


Fig. 31: Settings on the tablet

13 Important at the end: back up, lock, find help

13.1 Creating a backup regularly

A broken computer, a stolen laptop – without a backup all entries are gone. So create a backup regularly, for example once a month.

1. Click File › Create backup…
2. Choose a place *outside* the computer: a USB stick or an external hard disk.
3. Click Save.

The backup is encrypted, just like the database. You get it back with File › Restore backup / import… – or at the first start on a new computer with Import database… (Section 2.3 (p. 3)).

> **Caution:** Keep the printed **recovery key** separate from the backup. Anyone who has both can read the data.

13.2 Locking VitaParms

When you leave your desk, lock VitaParms with Ctrl + L (File › Log out / lock). VitaParms also locks itself when nothing has been entered for a while. You set how long under Tools › Settings….

13.3 What if …?

… **I see the wrong person?** At the top left you can see whose data are shown. Choose the right person there or press Ctrl + 1 or Ctrl + 2.

… **no reminder comes?** Reminders only appear while VitaParms is running and the responsible account is logged in. Check in the appointment whether an *Advance notice* is set. With Appointments › Check reminders now VitaParms checks immediately.

… **a window is too big for the screen?** Many windows can be scrolled. In the chart, fewer ticked panels or a larger window help (double-click the title bar).

... the language is wrong? Tools » Settings..., choose the language there. VitaParms then restarts.

... I have forgotten the password? In the login window Recovery key... (Section 2.5 (p. 5)).

... I have deleted something by mistake? A deleted measurement or appointment cannot be recovered – only from a backup. That is why VitaParms asks before every deletion.

13.4 What next?

You now know the most important steps. VitaParms can do even more, for example:

- keep a **medical record** with doctors' letters and findings as PDF,
- record the **care level**, the **disability card** and **advance directives** (living will, powers of attorney) in the master record,
- put the data encrypted on your **own website**, so that relatives or the home care service can view them on the go,
- create several **login accounts**, for example for a home care service.

All of this is described in the **user manual** – F1 key or Help » User manual.

Enjoy using VitaParms!